The Spanish battery on Sangley Point and Montojo's ships opened fire while still well out of range. Aware of his shortage of shells, Dewey waited half an hour before giving the laconic order to *Olympia*'s captain "You may fire when ready, Gridley." The American cruisers steamed back and forth on a course parallel to the static Spanish line, battering the enemy ships successively with port and starboard guns. By the fifth pass, just after 7:00 a.m., the Americans, peering through dense smoke, saw little sign that their guns were having any great effect. And indeed their fire was woefully inaccurate, 99 out of 100 shots missing their target, the increased range of contemporary guns having outstripped techniques for aiming. Nonetheless, Montojo's ships had taken appalling punishment.

At 7:35 a.m. Dewey received the startling news that his 5in guns were running short of ammunition. He signaled for a withdrawal to the center of the bay. His surprised crew were told this was a halt for breakfast, and took the chance to rest and eat.

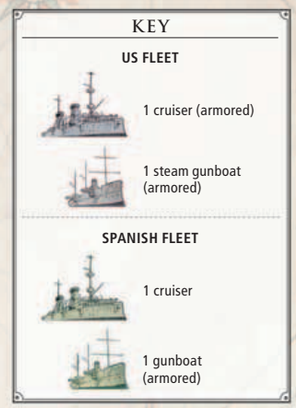
FINAL PHASE

During the break, the smoke cleared, and the dire condition of the Spanish ships was revealed; most had been fatally mauled. And to make matters worse, the Americans' ammunition turned out to be plentiful; only 15 rounds per 5in gun had been fired, while the report had suggested only 15 rounds per 5in gun remained. American casualties were also minimal; nine men had been injured, and one, Chief Engineer Randall, had died of heart failure when the fleet had entered the bay.

At 11:15 a.m., led by the cruiser *Baltimore*, Dewey's squadron returned to finish the job. With little resistance they pummeled the ships and shore batteries into surrender. In the afternoon, the Americans anchored off Manila and entertained Spanish sightseers gathered on the waterfront with the music of their bands.



Anniversary medal
This commemmorative medal shows a port-bow view of Dewey's flagship *Olympia*. Battle-ready, she has flags flying from her mainmast.



America in the ascendant
The second American assault on the Spanish fleet, made after the "breakfast break," saw the end of Spanish imperial power in the Pacific. The battle also marked the birth of America as a global power.